

Placement experience – VERIZON

- Surya narayanaan KC

About the company:

Verizon Communications is a prominent telecommunications company and a leader in technology and network solutions, consistently ranked among the Fortune 500. Established at the turn of the century, Verizon offers a range of services including wireless, broadband, and 5G connectivity, catering to both businesses and consumers globally. Verizon India has offices in major cities like Chennai, Bangalore, and Hyderabad, where it plays a crucial role in driving technological advancements and supporting Verizon's global operations.

About the Role:

The position they were hiring for was **Engineer 1 (Software Development)**. According to the HR, the role involves working with various technologies and across multiple domains. It's a dynamic position that provides exposure to a broad range of technical areas.

Placement Process

Round 1: Online Assessment

The online assessment was divided into three parts. The first part required us to write a 200-word paragraph on a general topic. The second part was a coding round, which included two easy-to-moderate level questions. I received one array question and one string-based problem. The third part tested our vocabulary and grammar skills, ensuring we had a strong grasp of language proficiency.

Round 2: Group Discussion:

In the group discussion round, we were divided into groups of 13. The panellist gave us a general topic to discuss, while other panels were assigned specific topics, such as Generative AI. The person leading my panel was very approachable, allowing everyone sufficient time to speak. I spoke twice during the discussion.

It's important to remain confident and speak clearly. Listening to others is equally crucial, and interruptions should be avoided. Be respectful of others' opinions while expressing your own. If you're unsure about the topic, stay calm and contribute thoughtful points.

Round 3: Technical Interview

The technical interview started with the interviewer reviewing my resume and asking about my extracurricular activities. To my surprise, he was familiar with a school near mine and asked me about my involvement in the AUSEC club, my role, and my achievements during school. Afterward, he inquired about my projects in detail. It's essential to have a solid understanding of the tech stack you've used and to be able to explain it in-depth.

The interviewer then posed scenario-based questions related to networking. He asked about IP addresses and DNS servers. Additionally, he gave me a scenario to modify a database according to specific requirements. Throughout the interview, the interviewer was very patient, giving me time to recall the topics and providing helpful hints when needed.

Round 4: HR Interview

The HR interview was relatively easy. The HR representative asked about my location preferences, my family background, and what I knew about the company. It was more of a casual conversation to understand my background and motivations.

Preparation Method I Followed

1. I focused on practicing problems on platforms like LeetCode and GeeksforGeeks (GFG) to improve my problem-solving skills
2. For DSA, I referred to Striver's A2Z sheet. It provided a clear roadmap for mastering the essential concepts and algorithms.
3. I made sure to equally concentrate on core subjects like DBMS, OOPs, and Networking. These are crucial for technical interviews, and a solid understanding of these topics helped me perform well in scenario-based questions and interviews.

Tips for the Interview:

- i. Remember, the interviewer knows that you're a fresher, so don't panic. Stay calm and approach the interview with a positive mindset.
- ii. Instead of treating the interview like a strict Q&A session, try to have a casual, friendly conversation. It helps in building rapport and makes the interview more comfortable.
- iii. Be well-versed with everything on your resume. Most of the questions will likely stem from your past experiences, projects, and extracurricular activities, so be prepared to explain them in detail.
- iv. Confidence is key! Trust in your preparation, stay confident while answering, and don't hesitate to admit if you're unsure about something. You can always ask for clarification or mention that you're open to learning.